Persist Week of June 15, 2026

REMINDER: Persist is no longer accessible through ATOM. To continue using Persist, you must log in through our new app. If you have not received your login instructions or are experiencing any issues, please contact us at support@functional-bodybuilding.com
We will continue to send a PDF version of training in our Persist only weekly newsletters.
This document may be created in advance of edits to the ongoing tracks in Persist, so while we try to minimize these discrepancies as much as possible, the version displayed in our app is always the most up to date. As always, please reach out using the chat bubble in our FBB app or on our website at https://functional-bodybuilding.com if you have any questions about the programming. It may be helpful to look over the week ahead to make sure your questions are all answered in time for your workout.

Pump Lift 5x
- Monday, June 15th, 2026
- Tuesday, June 16th, 2026
- Wednesday, June 17th, 2026
- Thursday, June 18th, 2026
- Friday, June 19th, 2026
- Saturday, June 20th, 2026
- Sunday, June 21st, 2026

Pump Lift 4x
- Monday, June 15th, 2026
- Tuesday, June 16th, 2026
- Wednesday, June 17th, 2026
- Thursday, June 18th, 2026
- Friday, June 19th, 2026
- Saturday, June 20th, 2026
- Sunday, June 21st, 2026

Pump Lift 3x
- Monday, June 15th, 2026
- Tuesday, June 16th, 2026
- Wednesday, June 17th, 2026
- Thursday, June 18th, 2026
- Friday, June 19th, 2026
- Saturday, June 20th, 2026
- Sunday, June 21st, 2026

- Pump Condition 5x
  - Monday, June 15th, 2026
  - Tuesday, June 16th, 2026
  - Wednesday, June 17th, 2026
  - Thursday, June 18th, 2026
  - Friday, June 19th, 2026
  - Saturday, June 20th, 2026
  - Sunday, June 21st, 2026
- Pump Condition 4x
  - Monday, June 15th, 2026
  - Tuesday, June 16th, 2026
  - Wednesday, June 17th, 2026
  - Thursday, June 18th, 2026
  - Friday, June 19th, 2026
  - Saturday, June 20th, 2026
  - Sunday, June 21st, 2026
- Pump Condition 3x
  - Monday, June 15th, 2026
  - Tuesday, June 16th, 2026
  - Wednesday, June 17th, 2026
  - Thursday, June 18th, 2026
  - Friday, June 19th, 2026
  - Saturday, June 20th, 2026
  - Sunday, June 21st, 2026
- Perform
  - Monday, June 15th, 2026
  - Tuesday, June 16th, 2026
  - Wednesday, June 17th, 2026
  - Thursday, June 18th, 2026
  - Friday, June 19th, 2026
  - Saturday, June 20th, 2026
  - Sunday, June 21st, 2026
- Minimalist
  - Monday, June 15th, 2026
  - Tuesday, June 16th, 2026
  - Wednesday, June 17th, 2026
  - Thursday, June 18th, 2026

Friday, June 19th, 2026
Saturday, June 20th, 2026
Sunday, June 21st, 2026

Pump Lift 5x

Monday, June 15th, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
DB Romanian Deadlift
The DB RDL is the primary hinge of this cycle. Dumbbells let each side work independently and give you more range of motion than a barbell. Use that. Push the hips back as far as you can before the low back rounds, then drive them forward to stand. Start lighter than you think you need to, because the 30X0 tempo will make even moderate weights feel heavy fast.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warm Up (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
-
3 Sets
1. Elephant Walk Step; 10-15/side
2. Banded Straight Arm Pulldown; 12-15

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
3 sets
Dumbbell Romanian Deadlift; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo; rest 90-120 sec between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets prior to your first working set. For Set 1-3, aim for RPE 7,8,9 respectively.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (10-12 min):
3-4 sets
Supinated Strict Pull Up; 6 reps @20X0 Tempo; rest 90 sec between sets
Loading Note:

Perform 2-3 warmup sets. For Set 1-4, aim for RPE 7, 8, 9, and 10, respectively. Match assistance or additional weight to make sure each set is challenging. Weeks 1 and 3 will focus more on strength for the pull up, while Weeks 2 and 4 will focus more on high volume and hypertrophy.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
1. Dumbbell Bent Over Row; 10-12 reps @21X1 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Ring Row; 10-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to close to failure within the rep range. This is a noncomplimentary superset that should lead to a large accumulation of fatigue in the pulling muscles.

F) Finisher (10 min):
3 sets
1. Ring Bicep Curl; 8-12 reps @30X0 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Waiter Curl; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Farmer's Walk; 30-50m
- rest 60-90 sec

Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set of each movement. Aim for each set to be close to failure on each movement.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec Right, 30 sec Left, 30 sec Center
2. Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30-60 sec
3. Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec

Tuesday, June 16th, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Bench Press

The bench press alternates with the 1-1/4 variation every other week. This week is the heavier, more traditional version, four sets building from RPE 7 to 10. The 21X1 tempo means 2 seconds down, 1 second pause, then explode up. That pause at the bottom removes any bounce off the chest and makes the hardest part of the lift harder. Don't rush the setup between sets.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warm Up (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
-
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Banded Face Pull; 15-20 reps
3. Half Kneeling Dumbbell Windmill; 6-10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
4 Sets
Bench Press; 6 reps @21X1 Tempo; rest 90-120 sec between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 2-3 warmup sets. Set 1-4: aim for RPE 7, 8, 9, 10, respectively.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
3 sets
1. Alternating Dumbbell Bench Press (Top Down); 8-10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15-30 sec
1. Dumbbell Pullover; 10-12 reps @21X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Set 1-3: RPE 8,9,10 respectively.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. JM Press; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Hands on Bench Push Up; 10-20 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set of each movement. Aim for each set to be close to failure within the prescribed rep range.

F) Finisher (12 min):
3 sets
1. Barbell Skullcrusher; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Weight Plate Turkish Sit Up; 8-12 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Hollow Body Flutter Kick; 20-40 sec
- rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
Perform 1 warm-up set of each movement to get familiar with it. Aim for each set to be close to failure. Each set will include a tricep exercise, a core exercise involving the tricep, and a secondary core exercise.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Seal Stretch; 30-60 sec
2. Scorpion Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Tall Kneeling Triceps Stretch; 30 sec/side

Wednesday, June 17th, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Cyclist Back Squat
The cyclist squat elevates the heels, which shifts the load forward onto the quads. It's one of the best ways to build quad size and strength without needing a leg extension machine. Keep your torso as upright as possible and let the knees track forward over the toes. That's exactly what the heel elevation is there for. If the weight feels light early, stay patient. The RPE climbs fast across four sets.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warm Up (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec cardio of choice
1. Straight Leg Bridge Hold; 30 sec
2. Wall Sit; 40-60 sec

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12-15 min):

4 sets
Cyclist Back Squat; 6-8 reps @20X0 Tempo; rest 2-3 min between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 2-3 warmup sets. Set 1-4, aim for RPE 7,8,9,10 respectively. The accumulated fatigue from each set should make the next set harder. This means you may increase weight OR you may keep the weight the same to match the prescribed RPE.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
3 sets
1. Dumbbell Suitcase Squat; 10-12 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15-30 sec
1. Dumbbell Suitcase Walking Lunge; 8-12 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
- rest 2 minutes between sets
Loading Note:
The goal here is high volume on the legs. The grip may be a limiter for some of you, so we recommend using weightlifting straps to get the most out of this section. Aim for each noncomplimentary set to be close to failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Barbell Hip Thrust Complex:
1. B Stance Hip Thrust (Left); 10-12 reps @20X1 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. B Stance Hip Thrust (Right); 10-12 reps @20X1 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Hip Thrust; 10-12 reps @20X1 Tempo
- rest 2 minutes between sets
Loading Note:
For this complex, you may perform with a banded setup, a barbell set up, or even bodyweight. All options should lead to a pretty big stimulus. Perform just a few reps of each movement to get familiar. For Set 1-3, aim for RPE 8, 9, and 10, respectively.

F) Finisher (10 min):
3 sets
1. Bent Knee Copenhagen Raise; 10-12 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Lateral Banded Walks; 15 steps/side
- rest 15 sec

1. Suitcase Standing Calf Raise; 20-30 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
The goal of this section is to focus on the quality of contractions of the smaller muscles in your lower body. You can push to failure, but make sure to keep the quality high.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Reclining Hero Pose; 60 sec
2. Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30-60 sec/side
3. Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Thursday, June 18th, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
40 min total work

Part 1: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
250-300m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
- 10 Alternating Low Switch Cossack Squats
- 10 Side Plank Hip Taps/side
*return to Row or Jog and repeat

Part 2: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
250-300m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
- 10 Reverse Plank Bridge with Hip Lift (hold 15 sec on last rep)
- 10 Tuck Ups (hold 15 sec on last rep)
*return to Row or Jog and repeat

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Ankles and Wrists
Ankle Circles x 5 reps/direction
Weighted ankle stretch x 1 min/side
Heel Sit x 1 min
Toe Sit x 1 min
Hand to Hand wrist circles x 30 sec

Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Isometrics x 3-5 reps with 5 sec hold
Quadruped Wrist Circles x 5-10 reps/direction

Friday, June 19th, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Strict Press
This cycle alternates between seated DB and barbell strict press. The seated position removes any back support, so the core and shoulder girdle have to work harder to stay stable under load. Sitting also removes any leg drive, so the shoulders and triceps do all the work. The rep range is 10-12 this week. Pick a weight you can control from the first rep to the last.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warm Up (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
-
3 Sets
1. Scap Pull Up; 5-7 reps with 3 sec pause and 3 sec lower.
2. DB Arm Bar; 5-7 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12-14 min):
4 Sets
Seated DB Strict Press; 10-12 reps @20X0; rest 90-120 sec between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Set 1-4: aim for RPE 8, 8, 9, and 10, respectively.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
3 sets
1. Lat Pulldown or Pronated Pull Up; 10-15 reps @21X0 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Seated Cable Row or DB Prone Row; 10-15 reps @21X0 Tempo
- rest 2 min between sets
Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set for each movement. Aim for each set to be close to failure within the rep range.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
1. Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 10-12 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Dumbbell Front Raise; 10-12 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Dumbbell Bent Over Reverse Fly; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 90-120 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set for each movement. Aim for each noncomplimentary superset to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (10 min):
3 sets
1. Incline Dumbbell Bicep Curl; 6-10 reps @40X0 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Cable Tricep Push Down; 12-15 @21X2 Tempo or Narrow Grip Tricep Push Down; 20-30 reps
- rest 60 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Passive Hang; 30 sec
2. Sidelying Thoracic Rotation with Reach; 5 reps/side
3. Seated Barbell Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30-60sec

Saturday, June 20th, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Front Squat
The front squat alternates between heavy low-rep work this week and higher volume next week. Three reps with a 33X1 tempo means three seconds down, three second pause in the hole, then explode up. The pause removes all momentum, making the quads, core, and upper back do all the

work. Use your warmup sets to dial in your front rack or cross-arm position. The pause will feel long. Sit with it.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warm Up (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
-
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. World's Greatest Stretch; 5/side
3. Standing Band Hip Abduction; 10-15 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
4 sets
Front Squat; 3 reps @33X1 Tempo; rest 90-120 sec between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 3-4 warmup sets. Set 1-4: aim for RPE 7, 8, 9, 10, respectively.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
3 sets
1. Goblet Tall Kneel to Stand; 10 reps/side @20X1 Tempo
- directly into
1. Goblet Cossack Squat; 10 reps/side @20X1 Tempo
- rest 90-120 sec between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets. Set 1-3, aim for RPE 7,8,9 respectively.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. DB Suitcase KOT Split Squat; 10 reps/side @21X0 Tempo
- rest 30 sec
1. Assisted KOT Squat; 10-15 reps @30X0 Tempo
- rest 60-90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set of each movement to determine the starting weight. Set 1-3: aim for RPE 7, 8, 9, respectively.

F) Finisher (10 min):

3 sets
1. Hanging Knee Tuck; 10-15 reps @21X1 Tempo
- rest 15-30 sec
1. Feet Anchored Sit Up; 10-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
Aim for each noncomplimentary superset to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Front Split; 30-60 sec/side
2. Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

Sunday, June 21st, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

Over the next four weeks, I want to walk you through what I consider the four essentials for making real progress. Not hacks, not shortcuts, just the foundational things that actually move the needle when you get them right. We'll cover one each week, and by the end you'll have a clearer picture of where your energy is best spent.

We're starting with one people consistently underestimate: sleep.

You can train hard, eat well, and still feel like you're spinning your wheels. A lot of the time, the missing piece isn't in the gym at all. It's in your bed.

Sleep is when your body actually does the work. Muscles repair, hormones reset, energy gets restored. When you short-change that process, everything gets harder. Your recovery slows down, your hunger increases, your motivation takes a hit. It's not a willpower problem. It's a biology problem.

Most people treat sleep like a luxury they'll catch up on someday. Start treating it like training. Protect it. Prioritize it. Seven to nine hours isn't a soft recommendation. It's part of the work.

Warmly,
Marcus

Pump Lift 4x

Monday, June 15th, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
DB Romanian Deadlift
The DB RDL is the primary hinge of this cycle. Push the hips back as far as you can before the low back rounds, then drive them forward to stand. The 30X0 tempo means the bar moves slowly on the way down. Start lighter than you think you need to. That tempo makes even moderate weights feel heavy fast.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
-
3 Sets
1. Elephant Walk Step; 10-15/side
2. Banded Straight Arm Pulldown; 12-15

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
3 sets
Dumbbell Romanian Deadlift; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo; rest 90-120 sec between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets prior to your first working set. For Set 1-3, aim for RPE 7,8,9 respectively. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (10-12 min):
3-4 sets
Supinated Strict Pull Up; 6 reps @20X0 Tempo; rest 90 sec between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 2-3 warmup sets. For Set 1-4, aim for RPE 7, 8, 9, and 10, respectively. Match assistance or additional weight to make sure each set is challenging. Weeks 1 and 3 will focus more on strength for the Pull Up, while Weeks 2 and 4 will focus more on high volume and hypertrophy.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
1. Dumbbell Bent Over Row; 10-12 reps @21X1 Tempo

- rest 15 sec
1. Ring Row; 10-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to close to failure within the rep range. This is a noncomplimentary superset that should lead to a large accumulation of fatigue in the pulling muscles.

F) Finisher (8-12 min):
3 sets
Barbell Hip Thrust Complex:
1. B Stance Hip Thrust (Left); 10-12 reps @20X1 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. B Stance Hip Thrust (Right); 10-12 reps @20X1 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Hip Thrust; 10-12 reps @20X1 Tempo
- rest 2 minutes between sets

Loading Note:
For this complex you may perform with a banded setup, a barbell set up, or even bodyweight. All options should lead to a pretty big stimulus. Perform just a few reps of each movement to get familiar. For Set 1-3, aim for RPE 8,9,10 respectively.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec Right, 30 sec Left, 30 sec Center
2. Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30-60 sec
3. Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec

Tuesday, June 16th, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Bench Press
The bench press alternates with the 1-1/4 version every other week. This week is the standard version, four sets building from RPE 7 to 10. The 21X1 tempo means two seconds down, one second pause at the chest, then explode up. That pause removes any bounce and makes the hardest part of the lift harder. Don't rush the setup between sets.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
-
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Banded Face Pull; 15-20 reps
3. Half Kneeling Dumbbell Windmill; 6-10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
4 Sets
Bench Press; 6 reps @21X1 Tempo; rest 90-120 sec between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 2-3 warmup sets. Set 1-4, aim for RPE 7,8,9,10 respectively.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
3 sets
1. Alternating Dumbbell Bench Press (Top Down); 8-10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15-30 sec
1. Dumbbell Pullover; 10-12 reps @21X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Set 1-3: RPE 8,9,10 respectively.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. JM Press; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Hands on Bench Push Up; 10-20 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set of each movement. Aim for each set to be close to failure within the prescribed rep range.

F) Finisher (12 min):
3 sets
1. Barbell Skullcrusher; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Weight Plate Turkish Sit Up; 8-12 reps @20X0 Tempo

- rest 15 sec
1. Hollow Body Flutter Kick; 20-40 sec
- rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set of each movement to get familiar. Aim for each set to be close to failure. Each set will include a tricep exercise, a core exercise with the tricep involved, and then a secondary core exercise.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Seal Stretch; 30-60 sec
2. Scorpion Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Tall Kneeling Triceps Stretch; 30 sec/side

Wednesday, June 17th, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Ankles and Wrists
Ankle Circles x 5 reps/direction
Weighted ankle stretch x 1 min/side
Heel Sit x 1 min
Toe Sit x 1 min
Hand to Hand wrist circles x 30 sec
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Isometrics x 3-5 reps with 5 sec hold
Quadruped Wrist Circles x 5-10 reps/direction

Thursday, June 18th, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Cyclist Back Squat

The cyclist squat elevates the heels, which shifts the load forward onto the quads. It is one of the best ways to build quad size and strength without a leg extension machine. Keep your torso as upright as possible and let the knees track forward over the toes. That is exactly what the heel elevation is there for. If the weight feels light early, stay patient. The RPE climbs fast across four sets.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Straight Leg Bridge Hold; 30 sec
3. Wall Sit; 40-60 sec

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12-15 min):
4 sets
Cyclist Back Squat; 6-8 reps @20X0 Tempo; rest 2-3 min between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 2-3 warmup sets. Set 1-4, aim for RPE 7,8,9,10 respectively. The accumulated fatigue from each set should make the next set harder. This means you may increase weight OR you may keep the weight the same to match the prescribed RPE.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
3 sets
1. Front Squat; 3 reps @33X1 Tempo
- rest 15-30 sec
1. Dumbbell Suitcase Walking Lunge; 8-12 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
- rest 2 minutes between sets
Loading Note:
The goal here is high volume on the legs. Focus on quality in the front squat and then burning the legs out with the lunges. Set 1-3, aim for RPE 8,9,10 respectively.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Goblet Tall Kneel to Stand; 10 reps/side @20X1 Tempo
- directly into
1. Goblet Cossack Squat; 10 reps/side @20X1 Tempo
- rest 90-120 sec between sets
Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets. Set 1-3, aim for RPE 7,8,9 respectively.

F) Finisher (10 min):
3 sets
1. Bent Knee Copenhagen Raise; 10-12 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Lateral Banded Walks; 15 steps/side
- rest 15 sec
1. Suitcase Standing Calf Raise; 20-30 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
The goal of this section is to focus on the quality of contractions of the smaller muscles in your lower body. You can push to failure, but make sure to keep the quality high.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Reclining Hero Pose; 60 sec
2. Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30-60 sec/side
3. Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Friday, June 19th, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Strict Press
This cycle alternates between seated DB and barbell strict press. The seated position removes any back support, so the core and shoulder girdle have to work harder to stay stable under load. Sitting also removes any leg drive, so the shoulders and triceps do all the work. The rep range is 10-12 this week. Pick a weight you can control from the first rep to the last.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
-
3 Sets
1. Scap Pull Up; 5-7 reps with 3 sec pause and 3 sec lower.
2. DB Arm Bar; 5-7 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12-14 min):

4 Sets
Seated Dumbbell Strict Press; 10-12 reps @20X0 Tempo; rest 90-120 sec between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Set 1-4: aim for RPE 8, 8, 9, 10, respectively.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
3 sets
1. Lat Pulldown or Pronated Pull Up; 10-15 reps @21X0 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Seated Cable Row or DB Prone Row; 10-15 reps @21X0 Tempo
- rest 2 min between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set for each movement. Aim for each set to be close to failure within the rep range.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
1. Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 10-12 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Dumbbell Front Raise; 10-12 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Dumbbell Bent Over Reverse Fly; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 90-120 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set for each movement. Aim for each noncomplimentary superset to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (10 min):
3 sets
1. Incline DB Bicep Curl; 6-10 reps @40X0 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Cable Tricep Push Down; 12-15 reps @21X2 Tempo or Narrow Grip Tricep Push Down; 20-30 reps
- rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets
1. Passive Hang; 30 sec
2. Sidelying Thoracic Rotation with Reach; 5 reps/side
3. Seated Barbell Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30-60sec

Saturday, June 20th, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
40 min total work

Part 1: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
250-300m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
- 10 Alternating Low Switch Cossack Squats
- 10 Side Plank Hip Taps/side
*return to Row or Jog and repeat

Part 2: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
250-300m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
- 10 Reverse Plank Bridge with Hip Lift (hold 15 sec on last rep)
- 10 Tuck Ups (hold 15 sec on last rep)
*return to Row or Jog and repeat

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (20 min):
20 min Full Body
1. Neck Circles x 3 reps/side
2. Kneeling Segmented Cat Cow x 5 reps
3. Banded Pass Through x 10 reps
4. Quadruped Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side
5. Yoga Push Up x 5 reps
6. Squat to Shinbox Switch x 10 reps/side
7. Squat Hip Rotations x 10 reps
8. Squat Thoracic Rotations x 5 reps/side
9. Cossack Squat x 5 reps/side
10. Long Split Squat x 30 sec/side
11. Forward Fold with Rotation x 5 reps/side

Sunday, June 21st, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x
Over the next four weeks, I want to walk you through what I consider the four essentials for making real progress. Not hacks, not shortcuts, just the foundational things that actually move the needle when you get them right. We'll cover one each week, and by the end you'll have a clearer picture of where your energy is best spent.
We're starting with one people consistently underestimate: sleep.
You can train hard, eat well, and still feel like you're spinning your wheels. A lot of the time, the missing piece isn't in the gym at all. It's in your bed.
Sleep is when your body actually does the work. Muscles repair, hormones reset, energy gets restored. When you short-change that process, everything gets harder. Your recovery slows down, your hunger increases, your motivation takes a hit. It's not a willpower problem. It's a biology problem.
Most people treat sleep like a luxury they'll catch up on someday. Start treating it like training. Protect it. Prioritize it. Seven to nine hours isn't a soft recommendation. It's part of the work.
Warmly, Marcus

Pump Lift 3x

Monday, June 15th, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
DB Romanian Deadlift
The DB RDL is the primary hinge of this cycle. Push the hips back as far as you can before the low back rounds, then drive them forward to stand. The 30X0 tempo means the bar moves slowly on the way down. Start lighter than you think you need to. That tempo makes even moderate weights feel heavy fast.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
-
3 Sets
1. Elephant Walk Step; 10-15/side
2. Banded Straight Arm Pulldown; 12-15

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):

3 sets
Dumbbell Romanian Deadlift; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo; rest 90-120 sec between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets prior to your first working set. For Set 1-3, aim for RPE 7, 8, and 9, respectively.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):
3 sets
1. Seated Dumbbell Strict Press; 8-10 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Dumbbell Bent Over Reverse Fly; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 90-120 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set for each movement. Aim for each noncomplimentary superset to be close to failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Goblet Tall Kneel to Stand; 10 reps/side @20X1 Tempo
- directly into
1. Goblet Cossack Squat; 10 reps/side @20X1 Tempo
- rest 90-120 sec between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets. Set 1-3: aim for RPE 7, 8, 9, respectively.

F) Finisher (10 min):
3 sets
1. Hanging Knee Tuck; 10-15 reps @21X1 Tempo
- rest 15-30 sec
1. Feet Anchored Sit Up; 10-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each noncomplimentary superset to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets

1. Reclining Hero Pose; 60 sec
2. Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30-60 sec/side
3. Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, June 16th, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or, if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Ankles and Wrists
Ankle Circles x 5 reps/direction
Weighted ankle stretch x 1 min/side
Heel Sit x 1 min
Toe Sit x 1 min
Hand to Hand wrist circles x 30 sec
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Isometrics x 3-5 reps with 5 sec hold
Quadruped Wrist Circles x 5-10 reps/direction

Wednesday, June 17th, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Bench Press
The bench press alternates with the 1-1/4 version every other week. This week is the standard version, four sets building from RPE 7 to 10. The 21X1 tempo means two seconds down, one second pause at the chest, then explode up. That pause removes any bounce and makes the hardest part of the lift harder. Don't rush the setup between sets.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
-
3 Sets

1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Banded Face Pull; 15-20 reps
3. Half Kneeling Dumbbell Windmill; 6-10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
4 Sets
Bench Press; 6 reps @21X1 Tempo; rest 90-120 sec between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 2-3 warmup sets. Set 1-4: aim for RPE 7, 8, 9, 10, respectively.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
3 sets
1. Dumbbell Suitcase Squat; 10-12 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15-30 sec
1. Dumbbell Suitcase Walking Lunge; 8-12 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
- rest 2 minutes between sets
Loading Note:
The goal here is high volume on the legs. The grip may be a limiter for some of you, so we recommend using weightlifting straps to get the most out of this section. Aim for each noncomplimentary set to be close to failure.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
1. Dumbbell Bent Over Row; 10-12 reps @21X1 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Ring Row; 10-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to close to failure within the rep range. This is a noncomplimentary superset that should lead to a large accumulation of fatigue in the pulling muscles.

F) Finisher (12 min):
3 sets
Barbell Hip Thrust Complex:
1. B Stance Hip Thrust (Left); 10-12 reps @20X1 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. B Stance Hip Thrust (Right); 10-12 reps @20X1 Tempo

- rest 15 sec
1. Hip Thrust; 10-12 reps @20X1 Tempo
- rest 2 minutes between sets

Loading Note:
For this complex, you may perform with a banded setup, a barbell set up, or even bodyweight. All options should lead to a pretty big stimulus. Perform just a few reps of each movement to get familiar. For Set 1-3, aim for RPE 8, 9, and 10, respectively.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec Right, 30 sec Left, 30 sec Center
2. Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30-60 sec
3. Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec

Thursday, June 18th, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or, if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (20 min):
20 min Full Body
1. Neck Circles x 3 reps/side
2. Kneeling Segmented Cat Cow x 5 reps
3. Banded Pass Through x 10 reps
4. Quadruped Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side
5. Yoga Push Up x 5 reps
6. Squat to Shinbox Switch x 10 reps/side
7. Squat Hip Rotations x 10 reps
8. Squat Thoracic Rotations x 5 reps/side
9. Cossack Squat x 5 reps/side
10. Long Split Squat x 30 sec/side
11. Forward Fold with Rotation x 5 reps/side

Friday, June 19th, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Cyclist Back Squat
The cyclist's squat elevates the heels, shifting the load forward onto the quads. It is one of the best ways to build quad size and strength without a leg extension machine. Keep your torso as upright as possible and let the knees track forward over the toes. That is exactly what the heel elevation is there for. If the weight feels light early, stay patient. The RPE climbs fast across four sets.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Straight Leg Bridge Hold; 30 sec
3. Wall Sit; 40-60 sec

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12-15 min):
4 sets
Cyclist Back Squat; 6-8 reps @20X0 Tempo; rest 2-3 min between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 2-3 warmup sets. Set 1-4: aim for RPE 7, 8, 9, 10, respectively. The accumulated fatigue from each set should make the next set harder. This means you may increase the weight or keep it the same to match the prescribed RPE.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (10-12 min):
3-4 sets
Supinated Strict Pull Up; 6 reps @20X0 Tempo; rest 90 sec between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 2-3 warmup sets. For Set 1-4, aim for RPE 7, 8, 9, and 10, respectively. Match assistance or additional weight to make sure each set is challenging. Weeks 1 and 3 will focus more on strength for the Pull Up, while Weeks 2 and 4 will focus more on high volume and hypertrophy.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. JM Press; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Hands on Bench Push Up; 10-20 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set of each movement. Aim for each set to be close to failure within the prescribed rep range.

F) Finisher (10 min):
3 sets
1. Ring Bicep Curl; 8-12 reps @30X0 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Waiter Curl; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Farmer's Walk; 30-50m
- rest 60-90 sec

Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set of each movement. Aim for each set to be close to failure on each movement.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Seal Stretch; 30-60 sec
2. Scorpion Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Tall Kneeling Triceps Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday, June 20th, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
40 min total work

Part 1: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
250-300m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
- 10 Alternating Low Switch Cossack Squats
- 10 Side Plank Hip Taps/side
*return to Row or Jog and repeat

Part 2: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
250-300m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
- 10 Reverse Plank Bridge with Hip Lift (hold 15 sec on last rep)
- 10 Tuck Ups (hold 15 sec on last rep)

*return to Row or Jog and repeat

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Middle Splits
1. Half Split Hip Hinge x 5-7 reps/side
2. Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 2 min
3. Middle Split x 2 min
4. Middle Split Hip Hinge x 10 reps
5. Middle Split Knee Bends x 10 reps
6. Bottom of Squat Hold x 1-2 min

Sunday, June 21st, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

Over the next four weeks, I want to walk you through what I consider the four essentials for making real progress. Not hacks, not shortcuts, just the foundational things that actually move the needle when you get them right. We'll cover one each week, and by the end you'll have a clearer picture of where your energy is best spent.

We're starting with one people consistently underestimate: sleep.

You can train hard, eat well, and still feel like you're spinning your wheels. A lot of the time, the missing piece isn't in the gym at all. It's in your bed.

Sleep is when your body actually does the work. Muscles repair, hormones reset, energy gets restored. When you short-change that process, everything gets harder. Your recovery slows down, your hunger increases, your motivation takes a hit. It's not a willpower problem. It's a biology problem.

Most people treat sleep like a luxury they'll catch up on someday. Start treating it like training. Protect it. Prioritize it. Seven to nine hours isn't a soft recommendation. It's part of the work.

Warmly,
Marcus

Pump Condition 5x

Monday, June 15th, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
DB Romanian Deadlift
The DB RDL is the primary hinge of this cycle. Push the hips back as far as you can before the low back rounds, then drive them forward to stand. The 30X0 tempo means the bar moves slowly on the way down. Start lighter than you think you need to. That tempo makes even moderate weights feel heavy fast.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
-
3 Sets
1. Elephant Walk Step; 10-15/side
2. Banded Straight Arm Pulldown; 12-15

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):
3 sets
Dumbbell Romanian Deadlift; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo; rest 90-120 sec between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets prior to your first working set. For Set 1-3, aim for RPE 7,8,9 respectively.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
1. Dumbbell Bent Over Row; 10-12 reps @21X1 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Ring Row; 10-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to close to failure within the rep range. This is a noncomplimentary superset that should lead to a large accumulation of fatigue in the pulling muscles.

E) Conditioning (15-16 min):
Every 2:30 x 6 Sets
8-12 Cal Row
5-7 Strict Pull Up
10-20 (5-10/side) Alternating Split Stance Single Arm KB Swing
Effort Note:
Set a timer for 6 sets of 2:30. Your goal is to complete all three movements in 2 minutes or less, leaving at least 30 seconds of rest between each set. The rep ranges are broad to allow for individual scaling. The effort will be sustainable but high because of the rest time between sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec Right, 30 sec Left, 30 sec Center
2. Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30-60 sec
3. Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec

Tuesday, June 16th, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Bench Press
The bench press alternates with the 1-1/4 version every other week. This week is the standard version, four sets building from RPE 7 to 10. The 21X1 tempo means two seconds down, one second pause at the chest, then explode up. That pause removes any bounce and makes the hardest part of the lift harder. Don't rush the setup between sets.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
-
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Banded Face Pull; 15-20 reps
3. Half Kneeling Dumbbell Windmill; 6-10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):
4 Sets
Bench Press; 6 reps @21X1 Tempo; rest 90-120 sec between sets
Loading Note:

Perform 2-3 warmup sets. Set 1-4, aim for RPE 7,8,9,10 respectively.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Alternating Dumbbell Bench Press (Top Down); 8-10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15-30 sec
1. Dumbbell Pullover; 10-12 reps @21X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Set 1-3: RPE 8,9,10 respectively.

E) Conditioning (15 min):
Every 60sec x 15 Sets
1st - 10-15 Strict Bar Dip or 8-12 Ring Dip
2nd - 8-12 Burpee Plate Jump
3rd - 40 sec Shuttle Run or 100m Run
Effort Note:
Every 60 sec you begin a new set, starting with the 1st, then the 2nd, then the 3rd. For your 4th set, return to 1st. The effort should remain sustainable for the entire 15 minutes. A short rest will be built into the workout between the completion of a movement and the start of the next 60 sec interval.
*Shuttle Run: Mark two points 10m apart. 1 rep = there and back.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Seal Stretch; 30-60 sec
2. Scorpion Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Tall Kneeling Triceps Stretch; 30 sec/side

Wednesday, June 17th, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Cyclist Back Squat
The cyclist's squat elevates the heels, shifting the load forward onto the quads. It is one of the best ways to build quad size and strength without a leg extension machine. Keep your torso as upright as possible and let the knees track forward over the toes. That is exactly what the heel elevation is there for. If the weight feels light early, stay patient. The RPE climbs fast across four sets.

Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Straight Leg Bridge Hold; 30 sec
3. Wall Sit; 40-60 sec

C) Strength Intensity (12-15 min):
4 sets
Cyclist Back Squat; 6-8 reps @20X0 Tempo; rest 2-3 min between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 2-3 warmup sets. Set 1-4: aim for RPE 7, 8, 9, 10, respectively. The accumulated fatigue from each set should make the next set harder. This means you may increase weight or keep it the same to match the prescribed RPE.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Barbell Hip Thrust Complex:
1. B Stance Hip Thrust (Left); 10-12 reps @20X1 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. B Stance Hip Thrust (Right); 10-12 reps @20X1 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Hip Thrust; 10-12 reps @20X1 Tempo
- rest 2 minutes between sets
Loading Note:
For this complex, you may perform with a banded setup, a barbell setup, or even bodyweight. All options should lead to a pretty big stimulus. Perform just a few reps of each movement to get familiar. For Set 1-3, aim for RPE 8, 9, and 10, respectively.

E) Conditioning (15-20 min):
3-4 Sets; increasing bike pace.
Bike 12-15 Cals
20 Dumbbell Suitcase Drop Lunge (10/side)
10 Box Jump Overs
Bike 12-15 Cals
rest walk 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:

For each set, gradually increase the bike's speed at the start and end. For the DB Lunge, select a weight that is about an RPE 7 on the first set, and then keep that weight for the remainder of the sets. The effort should be moderately high to allow for quality movement under fatigue and necessitate rest between sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Reclining Hero Pose; 60 sec
2. Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30-60 sec/side
3. Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Thursday, June 18th, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
40 min total work

Part 1: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
250-300m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
- 10 Alternating Low Switch Cossack Squats
- 10 Side Plank Hip Taps/side
*return to Row or Jog and repeat

Part 2: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
250-300m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
- 10 Reverse Plank Bridge with Hip Lift (hold 15 sec on last rep)
- 10 Tuck Ups (hold 15 sec on last rep)
*return to Row or Jog and repeat

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Ankles and Wrists
Ankle Circles x 5 reps/direction
Weighted ankle stretch x 1 min/side
Heel Sit x 1 min
Toe Sit x 1 min
Hand to Hand wrist circles x 30 sec
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min

Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Isometrics x 3-5 reps with 5 sec hold
Quadruped Wrist Circles x 5-10 reps/direction

Friday, June 19th, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Supinated Pull Up
The supinated grip puts the biceps in a stronger position on the bar, which means more help from the arms on every rep. Use that to push the weight or reduce band assistance further than you could with a pronated grip. Six reps are the focus of strength this week. Each set should feel tough. Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
-
3 Sets
1. Scap Pull Up; 5-7 reps with 3 sec pause and 3 sec lower.
2. Dumbbell Arm Bar; 5-7 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 2 (10-12 min):
3-4 sets
Supinated Strict Pull Up; 6 reps @20X0 Tempo; rest 90 sec between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 2-3 warmup sets. For Set 1-4, aim for RPE 7, 8, 9, and 10, respectively. Match assistance or additional weight to make sure each set is challenging. Weeks 1 and 3 will focus more on strength for the pull up, while Weeks 2 and 4 will focus more on high volume and hypertrophy.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
1. Seated Dumbbell Strict Press; 6-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Dumbbell Bent Over Reverse Fly; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 90-120 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set for each movement. Aim for each noncomplimentary superset to be close to failure.

E) Conditioning (15 min):
For Time
10-8-6-4-2
Wall Walks or 2x Inchworm Push Ups
20-16-12-8-4
Ring Row
20-16-12-8-4
Hanging Knee Tuck
*30m Farmer's Walk between rounds
15 min time cap.
Effort Note:
The heart rate should not spike very high during this conditioning piece. Each movement is intentionally designed to slow you down. Try to move consistently throughout the entire workout. Select a weight for the Farmer's Walk that is challenging, but you can complete unbroken for at least the first 10 minutes of the workout. The format of this workout goes as follows: 10 wall walks, 20 ring rows, 20 hanging knee tucks, 30m Farmer's Walk, then back to the top, 8 wall walks, 16 ring rows...

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Passive Hang; 30 sec
2. Sidelying Thoracic Rotation with Reach; 5 reps/side
3. Seated Barbell Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30-60sec

Saturday, June 20th, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Front Squat
The front squat alternates between heavy low-rep work this week and higher volume next week. Three reps with a 33X1 tempo means three seconds down, three-second pause in the hole, then explode up. The pause removes all momentum, making the quads, core, and upper back do all the work. Use your warmup sets to dial in your front rack or cross-arm position. The pause will feel long. Sit with it.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
-
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. World's Greatest Stretch; 5/side
3. Standing Band Hip Abduction; 10-15 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
4 sets
Front Squat; 3 reps @33X1 Tempo; rest 90-120 sec between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 3-4 warmup sets. Set 1-4: aim for RPE 7, 8, 9, 10, respectively.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. DB Suitcase KOT Split Squat; 10 reps/side @21X0 Tempo
- rest 30 sec
1. Assisted KOT Squat; 10-15 reps @30X0 Tempo
- rest 60-90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set of each movement to determine the starting weight. Set 1-3: aim for RPE 7, 8, 9, respectively.

E) Conditioning (15 min):
4 Rounds For Time
20/15 Cal Row (Male/Female)
20 Squat Jumps
20 Reverse Lunge (10/side)
20 Cross Body Toe Touch (10/side)
*15min Time Cap
Effort Note:
For this conditioning piece, the heart rate is meant to be high, and the goal is to keep moving. With bodyweight movements, it is easier for non-stop movement even when the legs or core are fatigued. Complete 4 rounds of the 4 movements with no rest between rounds.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets

1. Front Split; 30-60 sec/side
2. Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

Sunday, June 21st, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

Over the next four weeks, I want to walk you through what I consider the four essentials for making real progress. Not hacks, not shortcuts, just the foundational things that actually move the needle when you get them right. We'll cover one each week, and by the end you'll have a clearer picture of where your energy is best spent.

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Warmly,
Marcus

Pump Condition 4x

Monday, June 15th, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
DB Romanian Deadlift
The DB RDL is the primary hinge of this cycle. Push the hips back as far as you can before the low back rounds, then drive them forward to stand. The 30X0 tempo means the bar moves slowly on

the way down. Start lighter than you think you need to. That tempo makes even moderate weights feel heavy fast.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
-
3 Sets
1. Elephant Walk Step; 10-15/side
2. Banded Straight Arm Pulldown; 12-15

C) Strength Intensity (12-15 min):
3 sets
Dumbbell Romanian Deadlift; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo; rest 90-120 sec between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets prior to your first working set. For Set 1-3, aim for RPE 7, 8, and 9, respectively.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
1. Dumbbell Bent Over Row; 10-12 reps @21X1 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Ring Row; 10-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to close to failure within the rep range. This is a noncomplimentary superset that should lead to a large accumulation of fatigue in the pulling muscles.

E) Conditioning (15 min):
Every 2:30 x 6 Sets
8-12 Cal Row
5-7 Strict Pull Up
10-20 (5-10/side) Alternating Split Stance Single Arm KB Swing
Effort Note:
Set a timer for 6 sets of 2:30. Your goal is to complete all three movements in 2 minutes or less, leaving at least 30 seconds of rest between each set. The rep ranges are broad to allow for

individual scaling. The effort will be sustainable, but high because of the rest time between each set.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec Right, 30 sec Left, 30 sec Center
2. Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30-60 sec
3. Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec

Tuesday, June 16th, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Week 1 - Bench Press
The bench press alternates with the 1-1/4 version every other week. This week is the standard version, four sets building from RPE 7 to 10. The 21X1 tempo means two seconds down, one second pause at the chest, then explode up. That pause removes any bounce and makes the hardest part of the lift harder. Don't rush the setup between sets.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
-
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Banded Face Pull; 15-20 reps
3. Half Kneeling Dumbbell Windmill; 6-10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):
4 Sets
Bench Press; 6 reps @21X1 Tempo; rest 90-120 sec between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 2-3 warmup sets. Set 1-4: aim for RPE 7, 8, 9, 10, respectively.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Alternating Dumbbell Bench Press (Top Down); 8-10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15-30 sec
1. Dumbbell Pullover; 10-12 reps @21X0 Tempo

- rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Set 1-3: RPE 8,9,10 respectively.

E) Conditioning (15 min):
Every 60sec x 15 Sets
1st - 10-15 Strict Bar Dip or 8-12 Ring Dip
2nd - 8-12 Burpee Plate Jump
3rd - 40 sec Shuttle Run or 100m Run
Effort Note:
Every 60 sec you begin a new set, starting with the 1st, then the 2nd, then the 3rd. For your 4th set, return to 1st. The effort should remain sustainable for the entire 15 minutes. A short rest will be built into the workout between the completion of a movement and the start of the next 60 sec interval.
*Shuttle Run: Mark two points 10m apart. 1 rep = there and back.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Seal Stretch; 30-60 sec
2. Scorpion Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Tall Kneeling Triceps Stretch; 30 sec/side

Wednesday, June 17th, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Ankles and Wrists
Ankle Circles x 5 reps/direction
Weighted ankle stretch x 1 min/side
Heel Sit x 1 min
Toe Sit x 1 min
Hand to Hand wrist circles x 30 sec
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Isometrics x 3-5 reps with 5 sec hold

Quadruped Wrist Circles x 5-10 reps/direction

Thursday, June 18th, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Cyclist Back Squat
The cyclist squat elevates the heels, which shifts the load forward onto the quads. It is one of the best ways to build quad size and strength without a leg extension machine. Keep your torso as upright as possible and let the knees track forward over the toes. That is exactly what the heel elevation is there for. If the weight feels light early, stay patient. The RPE climbs fast across four sets.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Straight Leg Bridge Hold; 30 sec
3. Wall Sit; 40-60 sec

C) Strength Intensity (12-15 min):
4 sets
Cyclist Back Squat; 6-8 reps @20X0 Tempo; rest 2-3 min between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 2-3 warmup sets. Set 1-4: aim for RPE 7, 8, 9, 10, respectively. The accumulated fatigue from each set should make the next set harder. This means you may increase weight OR you may keep the weight the same to match the prescribed RPE.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Barbell Hip Thrust Complex:
1. B Stance Hip Thrust (Left); 10-12 reps @20X1 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. B Stance Hip Thrust (Right); 10-12 reps @20X1 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Hip Thrust; 10-12 reps @20X1 Tempo
- rest 2 minutes between sets
Loading Note:

For this complex, you may perform with a banded setup, a barbell setup, or even bodyweight. All options should lead to a pretty big stimulus. Perform just a few reps of each movement to get familiar. For Set 1-3, aim for RPE 8, 9, and 10, respectively.

E) Conditioning (15-20 min):
3-4 Sets; increasing bike pace.
Bike 12-15 Cals
20 Dumbbell Suitcase Drop Lunge (10/side)
10 Box Jump Overs
Bike 12-15 Cals
rest walk 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:
For each set, gradually increase the bike's speed at the start and end. For the DB Lunge, select a weight that is about an RPE 7 on the first set, and then keep that weight for the remainder of the sets. The effort should be moderately high to allow for quality movement under fatigue and necessitate rest between sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Reclining Hero Pose; 60 sec
2. Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30-60 sec/side
3. Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Friday, June 19th, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Supinated Pull Up
The supinated grip puts the biceps in a stronger position on the bar, which means more help from the arms on every rep. Use that to push the weight or reduce band assistance further than you could with a pronated grip. Six reps is the strength focus. Each set should feel tough.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
-
3 Sets
1. Scap Pull Up; 5-7 reps with 3 sec pause and 3 sec lower.
2. DB Arm Bar; 5-7 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (10-12 min):
3-4 sets
Supinated Strict Pull Up; 6 reps @20X0 Tempo; rest 90 sec between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 2-3 warmup sets. For Set 1-4, aim for RPE 7, 8, 9, and 10, respectively. Match assistance or additional weight to make sure each set is challenging. Weeks 1 and 3 will focus more on strength for the Pull Up, while Weeks 2 and 4 will focus more on high volume and hypertrophy.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
1. Seated Dumbbell Strict Press; 6-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Dumbbell Bent Over Reverse Fly; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 90-120 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set for each movement. Aim for each noncomplimentary superset to be close to failure.

E) Conditioning (15 min):
For Time
10-8-6-4-2
Wall Walks or 2x Inchworm Push Ups
20-16-12-8-4
Ring Row
20-16-12-8-4
Hanging Knee Tuck
*30m Farmer's Walk between rounds
15 min time cap.
Effort Note:
The heart rate should not spike very high during this conditioning piece. Each movement is intentionally designed to slow you down. Try to move consistently throughout the entire workout. Select a weight for the Farmer's Walk that is challenging, but you can complete unbroken for at least the first 10 minutes of the workout. The format of this workout goes as follows: 10 wall walks, 20 ring rows, 20 hanging knee tucks, 30m Farmer's Walk, then back to the top, 8 wall walks, 16 ring rows...

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Passive Hang; 30 sec
2. Sidelying Thoracic Rotation with Reach; 5 reps/side
3. Seated Barbell Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30-60sec

Saturday, June 20th, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
40 min total work

Part 1: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
250-300m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
- 10 Alternating Low Switch Cossack Squats
- 10 Side Plank Hip Taps/side
*return to Row or Jog and repeat

Part 2: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
250-300m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
- 10 Reverse Plank Bridge with Hip Lift (hold 15 sec on last rep)
- 10 Tuck Ups (hold 15 sec on last rep)
*return to Row or Jog and repeat

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (20 min):
20 min Full Body
1. Neck Circles x 3 reps/side
2. Kneeling Segmented Cat Cow x 5 reps
3. Banded Pass Through x 10 reps
4. Quadruped Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side
5. Yoga Push Up x 5 reps
6. Squat to Shinbox Switch x 10 reps/side
7. Squat Hip Rotations x 10 reps
8. Squat Thoracic Rotations x 5 reps/side
9. Cossack Squat x 5 reps/side
10. Long Split Squat x 30 sec/side

11. Forward Fold with Rotation x 5 reps/side

Sunday, June 21st, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

Over the next four weeks, I want to walk you through what I consider the four essentials for making real progress. Not hacks, not shortcuts, just the foundational things that actually move the needle when you get them right. We'll cover one each week, and by the end you'll have a clearer picture of where your energy is best spent.

We're starting with one people consistently underestimate: sleep.

You can train hard, eat well, and still feel like you're spinning your wheels. A lot of the time, the missing piece isn't in the gym at all. It's in your bed.

Sleep is when your body actually does the work. Muscles repair, hormones reset, energy gets restored. When you short-change that process, everything gets harder. Your recovery slows down, your hunger increases, your motivation takes a hit. It's not a willpower problem. It's a biology problem.

Most people treat sleep like a luxury they'll catch up on someday. Start treating it like training. Protect it. Prioritize it. Seven to nine hours isn't a soft recommendation. It's part of the work.

Warmly,
Marcus

Pump Condition 3x

Monday, June 15th, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
DB Romanian Deadlift
The DB RDL is the primary hinge of this cycle. Push the hips back as far as you can before the low back rounds, then drive them forward to stand. The 30X0 tempo means the bar moves slowly on

the way down. Start lighter than you think you need to. That tempo makes even moderate weights feel heavy fast.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
-
3 Sets
1. Elephant Walk Step; 10-15/side
2. Banded Straight Arm Pulldown; 12-15

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):
3 sets
Dumbbell Romanian Deadlift; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo; rest 90-120 sec between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets prior to your first working set. For Set 1-3, aim for RPE 7, 8, and 9, respectively.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
1. Seated Dumbbell Strict Press; 6-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Dumbbell Bent Over Reverse Fly; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 90-120 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set for each movement. Aim for each noncomplimentary superset to be close to failure.

E) Conditioning (15-20 min):
3-4 Sets; increasing bike pace.
Bike 12-15 Cals
20 Dumbbell Suitcase Drop Lunge (10/side)
10 Box Jump Overs
Bike 12-15 Cals
rest walk 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:

For each set, gradually increase the bike's speed at the start and end. For the DB Lunge, select a weight that is about an RPE 7 on the first set, and then keep that weight for the remainder of the sets. The effort should be moderately high to allow for quality movement under fatigue and necessitate rest between sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Reclining Hero Pose; 60 sec
2. Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30-60 sec/side
3. Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, June 16th, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Ankles and Wrists
Ankle Circles x 5 reps/direction
Weighted ankle stretch x 1 min/side
Heel Sit x 1 min
Toe Sit x 1 min
Hand to Hand wrist circles x 30 sec
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Isometrics x 3-5 reps with 5 sec hold
Quadruped Wrist Circles x 5-10 reps/direction

Wednesday, June 17th, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Bench Press
The bench press alternates with the 1-1/4 version every other week. This week is the standard version, four sets building from RPE 7 to 10. The 21X1 tempo means two seconds down, one

second pause at the chest, then explode up. That pause removes any bounce and makes the hardest part of the lift harder. Don't rush the setup between sets.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
-
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Banded Face Pull; 15-20 reps
3. Half Kneeling Dumbbell Windmill; 6-10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):
4 Sets
Bench Press; 6 reps @21X1 Tempo; rest 90-120 sec between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 2-3 warmup sets. Set 1-4: aim for RPE 7, 8, 9, 10, respectively.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
1. Dumbbell Bent Over Row; 10-12 reps @21X1 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Ring Row; 10-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to close to failure within the rep range. This is a noncomplimentary superset that should lead to a large accumulation of fatigue in the pulling muscles.

E) Conditioning (15 min):
4 Rounds For Time
20/15 Cal Row (Male/Female)
20 Squat Jumps
20 Reverse Lunge (10/side)
20 Cross Body Toe Touch (10/side)
*15min Time Cap
Effort Note:

For this conditioning piece, the heart rate is meant to be high, and the goal is to keep moving. With bodyweight movements, it is easier for non-stop movement even when the legs or core are fatigued. Complete 4 rounds of the 4 movements with no rest between rounds.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec Right, 30 sec Left, 30 sec Center
2. Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30-60 sec
3. Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec

Thursday, June 18th, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or, if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (20 min):
20 min Full Body
1. Neck Circles x 3 reps/side
2. Kneeling Segmented Cat Cow x 5 reps
3. Banded Pass Through x 10 reps
4. Quadruped Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side
5. Yoga Push Up x 5 reps
6. Squat to Shinbox Switch x 10 reps/side
7. Squat Hip Rotations x 10 reps
8. Squat Thoracic Rotations x 5 reps/side
9. Cossack Squat x 5 reps/side
10. Long Split Squat x 30 sec/side
11. Forward Fold with Rotation x 5 reps/side

Friday, June 19th, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Cyclist Back Squat
The cyclist's squat elevates the heels, shifting the load forward onto the quads. It is one of the best ways to build quad size and strength without a leg extension machine. Keep your torso as upright

as possible and let the knees track forward over the toes. That is exactly what the heel elevation is there for. If the weight feels light early, stay patient. The RPE climbs fast across four sets.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Straight Leg Bridge Hold; 30 sec
3. Wall Sit; 40-60 sec

C) Strength Intensity (12-15 min):
4 sets
Cyclist Back Squat; 6-8 reps @20X0 Tempo; rest 2-3 min between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 2-3 warmup sets. Set 1-4: aim for RPE 7, 8, 9, 10, respectively. The accumulated fatigue from each set should make the next set harder. This means you may increase weight, or you may keep the weight the same to match the prescribed RPE.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. JM Press; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Hands on Bench Push Up; 10-20 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set of each movement. Aim for each set to be close to failure within the prescribed rep range.

E) Conditioning (15 min):
Every 60sec x 15 Sets
1st - 10-15 Strict Bar Dip or 8-12 Ring Dip
2nd - 8-12 Burpee Plate Jump
3rd - 40 sec Shuttle Run or 100m Run
Effort Note:
Every 60 sec you begin a new set, starting with the 1st, then the 2nd, then the 3rd. For your 4th set, return to 1st. The effort should remain sustainable for the entire 15 minutes. A short rest will be built into the workout between the completion of a movement and the start of the next 60 sec interval.

*Shuttle Run: Mark two points 10m apart. 1 rep = there and back.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Seal Stretch; 30-60 sec
2. Scorpion Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Tall Kneeling Triceps Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday, June 20th, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
40 min total work

Part 1: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
250-300m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
- 10 Alternating Low Switch Cossack Squats
- 10 Side Plank Hip Taps/side
*return to Row or Jog and repeat

Part 2: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
250-300m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
- 10 Reverse Plank Bridge with Hip Lift (hold 15 sec on last rep)
- 10 Tuck Ups (hold 15 sec on last rep)
*return to Row or Jog and repeat

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Middle Splits
1. Half Split Hip Hinge x 5-7 reps/side
2. Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 2 min
3. Middle Split x 2 min
4. Middle Split Hip Hinge x 10 reps
5. Middle Split Knee Bends x 10 reps
6. Bottom of Squat Hold x 1-2 min

Sunday, June 21st, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

Over the next four weeks, I want to walk you through what I consider the four essentials for making real progress. Not hacks, not shortcuts, just the foundational things that actually move the needle when you get them right. We'll cover one each week, and by the end you'll have a clearer picture of where your energy is best spent.

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Most people treat sleep like a luxury they'll catch up on someday. Start treating it like training. Protect it. Prioritize it. Seven to nine hours isn't a soft recommendation. It's part of the work.

Warmly,
Marcus

Perform

Monday, June 15th, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
DB Romanian Deadlift
The DB RDL is the primary hinge of this cycle. Push the hips back as far as you can before the low back rounds, then drive them forward to stand. The 30X0 tempo means the bar moves slowly on the way down. Start lighter than you think you need to. That tempo makes even moderate weights feel heavy fast.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
-
3 Sets
1. Elephant Walk Step; 10-15/side
2. Banded Straight Arm Pulldown; 12-15

C) Gymnastics HOT START (12 min):
Every 60 sec x 12 sets
Min 1) Ring Muscle Up (Max Unbroken Reps Minus 1-2 reps)
Min 2) Handstand Walk 15m
Min 3) Bike 8-10 Cals (faster each set)
Effort Note: This section is meant to prioritize muscular endurance in the muscle-up under some fatigue. If you cannot perform a muscle-up, you may substitute a muscle-up row. If your max unbroken set is less than 5 reps, you may perform a 40-second As Many Reps As Possible (AMRAP) of muscle-ups in the first minute.

D) Strength Intensity (12 min):
3 sets
Dumbbell Romanian Deadlift; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo; rest 90-120 sec between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets prior to your first working set. For Set 1-3, aim for RPE 7, 8, and 9, respectively.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
1. Dumbbell Bent Over Row; 10-12 reps @21X1 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Ring Row; 10-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to close to failure within the rep range. This is a noncomplimentary superset that should lead to a large accumulation of fatigue in the pulling muscles.

F) Conditioning (15 min):
Every 2:30 x 6 Sets
8-12 Cal Row

5-7 Strict Pull Up
10-20 (5-10/side) Alternating Split Stance Single Arm KB Swing
Effort Note:
Aim to complete the work with about 30 seconds of rest. The pace on all movements should be sustainable throughout the workout. For the KB movement, choose a weight that you can perform all sets unbroken, but is fatiguing for the glutes on each set.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec Right, 30 sec Left, 30 sec Center
2. Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30-60 sec
3. Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec

Tuesday, June 16th, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Bench Press
The bench press alternates with the 1-1/4 version every other week. This week is the standard version, four sets building from RPE 7 to 10. The 21X1 tempo means two seconds down, one second pause at the chest, then explode up. That pause removes any bounce and makes the hardest part of the lift harder. Don't rush the setup between sets.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Chipper based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
-
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Banded Face Pull; 15-20 reps
3. Half Kneeling Dumbbell Windmill; 6-10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):
4 Sets
Bench Press; 6 reps @21X1 Tempo; rest 90-120 sec between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 2-3 warmup sets. Set 1-4: aim for RPE 7, 8, 9, 10, respectively.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Alternating Dumbbell Bench Press (Top Down); 8-10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15-30 sec
1. Dumbbell Pullover; 10-12 reps @21X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Set 1-3: RPE 8,9,10 respectively.

E) Chipper (20 min):
3 sets
20 Cal Bike
20 Ring Push Ups @20X0 Tempo
20 Alternating Dumbbell Snatch (10/side)
50 DU or 75 Single Unders
20 Strict Bar Dips or 20 Ring Dips or 30 Bench Dips
20 Alternating DB Snatch (10/side)
20 Cal Bike
rest 2 min between sets

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Seal Stretch; 30-60 sec
2. Scorpion Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Tall Kneeling Triceps Stretch; 30 sec/side

Wednesday, June 17th, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Cyclist Back Squat
The cyclist's squat elevates the heels, shifting the load forward onto the quads. It is one of the best ways to build quad size and strength without a leg extension machine. Keep your torso as upright as possible and let the knees track forward over the toes. That is exactly what the heel elevation is there for. If the weight feels light early, stay patient. The RPE climbs fast across four sets.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds

1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Straight Leg Bridge Hold; 30 sec
3. Wall Sit; 40-60 sec

C) Speed Strength - Snatch (15-18 min):
Barbell Warm-up:
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Snatch Grip Romanian Deadlift
10 BTN Snatch Press or BTN Snatch Push Press
10 Overhead Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Snatch Grip Hold
10 sec Snatch Grip Overhead Hold
10 sec Overhead Squat Hold
-
Every 2:00 x 6 sets
2 Muscle Snatch + 2 Overhead Squat
- directly into
4 Burpee High Jump
- rest until the next 2:00
Sets 1-2: Easy
Set 3-4: Moderate
Set 5-6: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity (12-15 min):
4 sets
Cyclist Back Squat; 6-8 reps @20X0 Tempo; rest 2-3 min between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 2-3 warmup sets. Set 1-4: aim for RPE 7, 8, 9, 10, respectively. The accumulated fatigue from each set should make the next set harder. This means you may increase weight, or you may keep the weight the same to match the prescribed RPE.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Barbell Hip Thrust Complex:
1. B Stance Hip Thrust (Left); 10-12 reps @20X1 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. B Stance Hip Thrust (Right); 10-12 reps @20X1 Tempo
- rest 15 sec

1. Hip Thrust; 10-12 reps @20X1 Tempo
- rest 2 minutes between sets

Loading Note:
For this complex, you may perform with a banded setup, a barbell setup, or even bodyweight. All options should lead to a pretty big stimulus. Perform just a few reps of each movement to get familiar. For Set 1-3, aim for RPE 8, 9, and 10, respectively.

F) Conditioning (15 min):
4 Rounds For Time
300m Run
20 Squat Jumps
20 Reverse Lunge (10/side)
20 GHD Sit Ups
*15min Time Cap
Effort Note:
For this conditioning piece, the heart rate is meant to be high, and the goal is to keep moving. With bodyweight movements, it is easier for non stop movement even when the legs or core are fatigued.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Reclining Hero Pose; 60 sec
2. Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30-60 sec/side
3. Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Thursday, June 18th, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PERFORM

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
40 min total work

Part 1: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
250-300m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
- 10 Alternating Low Switch Cossack Squats
- 10 Side Plank Hip Taps/side
*return to Row or Jog and repeat

Part 2: 20 min timer (continuous movement):

250-300m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
- 10 Reverse Plank Bridge with Hip Lift (hold 15 sec on last rep)
- 10 Tuck Ups (hold 15 sec on last rep)
*return to Row or Jog and repeat

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Ankles and Wrists
Ankle Circles x 5 reps/direction
Weighted ankle stretch x 1 min/side
Heel Sit x 1 min
Toe Sit x 1 min
Hand to Hand wrist circles x 30 sec
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Isometrics x 3-5 reps with 5 sec hold
Quadruped Wrist Circles x 5-10 reps/direction

Friday, June 19th, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Supinated Pull Up
The supinated grip puts the biceps in a stronger position on the bar, which means more help from the arms on every rep. Use that to push the weight or reduce band assistance further than you could with a pronated grip. The six reps is a strength focus range. Each set should feel tough. Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
-
3 Sets
1. Scap Pull Up; 5-7 reps with 3 sec pause and 3 sec lower.
2. DB Arm Bar; 5-7 reps/side

C) Dynamic Effort Upper (12-15 min):
4-5 sets
1. Single Arm Dumbbell Push Press; 6-8 reps/side @20X1 Tempo
- rest 15 sec

1. Plyo Push Up 5-8 reps
- rest 60 sec and back to 1

D) Strength Intensity (10-12 min):
3-4 sets
Supinated Strict Pull Up; 6 reps @20X0 Tempo; rest 90 sec between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 2-3 warmup sets. For Set 1-4, aim for RPE 8, 8, 9, and 10, respectively. Match assistance or additional weight to make sure each set is challenging. Weeks 1 and 3 will focus more on strength for the Pull Up, while Weeks 2 and 4 will focus more on high volume and hypertrophy.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
1. Seated Strict Press; 6-8 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Dumbbell Bent Over Reverse Fly; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 90-120 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set for each movement. Aim for each noncomplimentary superset to be close to failure.

F) Conditioning (15 min):
For Time
10-8-6-4-2
Wall Walks or 2x Inchworm Push Ups
20-16-12-8-4
Ring Row
20-16-12-8-4
Weighted Hanging Knee Tuck
*30m Farmer's Walk between rounds
15 min time cap.
Effort Note:
The heart rate should not spike very high during this conditioning piece. Each movement is intentionally designed to slow you down. Try to move consistently throughout the entire workout. Select a weight for the Farmer's Walk that is challenging, but you can complete unbroken for at least the first 10 minutes of the workout.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Passive Hang; 30 sec
2. Sidelying Thoracic Rotation with Reach; 5 reps/side
3. Seated Barbell Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30-60sec

Saturday, June 20th, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Front Squat
The front squat alternates between heavy low-rep work this week and higher volume next week. Three reps with a 33X1 tempo means three seconds down, three second pause in the hole, then explode up. The pause removes all momentum, making the quads, core, and upper back do all the work. Use your warmup sets to dial in your front rack or cross-arm position. The pause will feel long. Sit with it.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
-
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. World's Greatest Stretch; 5/side
3. Standing Band Hip Abduction; 10-15 reps/side

C) Speed Strength - Clean (15-18 min):
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Romanian Deadlift
10 Strict Press
10 Front Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Clean Grip Hold
10 sec Front Rack Hold
10 sec Front Squat Hold
-
Every 2:00 x 6 sets
3 Low Hang Squat Clean
Sets 1-2: Easy

Set 3-4: Moderate
Set 5-6: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity (12 min):
3-4 sets
Front Squat; 3 reps @33X1 Tempo; rest 90-120 sec between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 3-4 warmup sets. Set 1-4, aim for RPE 7,8,9,10 respectively.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. DB Suitcase KOT Split Squat; 10 reps/side @21X0 Tempo
- rest 30 sec
1. Assisted KOT Squat; 10-15 reps @30X0 Tempo
- rest 60-90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set of each movement to determine the starting weight. Set 1-3: aim for RPE 7, 8, 9, respectively.

F) Conditioning (15 min):
3-4 Sets; increasing bike pace.
Bike 12-15 Cals
20 Dumbbell Suitcase Drop Lunge (10/side)
10 Box Jump Overs
Bike 12-15 Cals
rest walk 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:
The goal of this conditioning piece is to continue to accumulate fatigue in the lower body. For each set, aim to increase the bike's speed at the start and end. Note the bike appears at both the start and end of each set. For the DB Lunge, select a weight that is about an RPE 7 on the first set, and then keep that weight for the remainder of the sets.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Front Split; 30-60 sec/side
2. Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

Sunday, June 21st, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PERFORM

Over the next four weeks, I want to walk you through what I consider the four essentials for making real progress. Not hacks, not shortcuts, just the foundational things that actually move the needle when you get them right. We'll cover one each week, and by the end you'll have a clearer picture of where your energy is best spent.

We're starting with one people consistently underestimate: sleep.

You can train hard, eat well, and still feel like you're spinning your wheels. A lot of the time, the missing piece isn't in the gym at all. It's in your bed.

Sleep is when your body actually does the work. Muscles repair, hormones reset, energy gets restored. When you short-change that process, everything gets harder. Your recovery slows down, your hunger increases, your motivation takes a hit. It's not a willpower problem. It's a biology problem.

Most people treat sleep like a luxury they'll catch up on someday. Start treating it like training. Protect it. Prioritize it. Seven to nine hours isn't a soft recommendation. It's part of the work.

Warmly,
Marcus

Minimalist

Monday, June 15th, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist Minimalist

A) Daily Focus Notes:
DB Romanian Deadlift
The DB RDL is the primary hinge of this cycle. Push the hips back as far as you can before the low back rounds, then drive them forward to stand. The 30X0 tempo means the dumbbells move slowly on the way down. Start lighter than you think you need to. That tempo makes even moderate weights feel heavy fast.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
-
3 Sets
1. Elephant Walk Step; 10-15/side
2. Banded Straight Arm Pulldown; 12-15

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):
3 sets
Dumbbell Romanian Deadlift; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo; rest 90-120 sec between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets prior to your first working set. For Set 1-3, aim for RPE 7, 8, and 9, respectively.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
1. Dumbbell Bent Over Row; 10-12 reps @21X1 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Alternating Dumbbell Curl; 8-10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Aim for each set to close to failure within the rep range. This is a noncomplimentary superset that should lead to a large accumulation of fatigue in the pulling muscles.

E) Conditioning (15 min):
5 Rounds For Time
20 Squat Jumps
20 Reverse Lunge (10/side)
40 Mountain Climbers (20/side)
20 Cross Body Toe Touch (10/side)
*15min Time Cap
Effort Note:
For this conditioning piece, the heart rate is meant to be high, and the goal is to keep moving. With bodyweight movements, it is easier for non stop movement even when the legs or core are fatigued.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets
1. Pancake Stretch; 30 sec Right, 30 sec Left, 30 sec Center
2. Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30-60 sec
3. Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec

Tuesday, June 16th, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist Minimalist

A) Daily Focus Notes:
DB Bench Press
The DB bench press alternates with the 1-1/4 version every other week. Each dumbbell moves independently, which means both sides have to do their own work. The 21X1 tempo means two seconds down, one second pause at the chest, then explode up. That pause removes any bounce from the bottom. Start with a weight you can control through all eight reps.
Short on time? Remove Strength Intensity 2 or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
-
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Banded Face Pull; 15-20 reps
3. Half Kneeling Dumbbell Windmill; 6-10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
3-4 sets
Dumbbell Bench Press; 8 reps @21X1 Tempo; rest 90-120 sec between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets. Set 1-4: aim for RPE 7, 8, 9, 10, respectively.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
3 sets
1. Dumbbell Pullover; 10-12 reps @21X0 Tempo
- rest 15-30 sec
1. Deficit Push Up; 8-12 reps @21X1 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set to determine the starting weight. Set 1-3: RPE 8,9,10 respectively.

E) Conditioning (12-15 min):
Every 60sec x 12-15 Sets
1st - 15-20 Bench Dips
2nd - 8-12 No Jump Burpee
3rd - 40 sec Shuttle Run or 100m Run
Effort Note:
Do not rush through each movement; start with a steady pace and gradually increase speed as the sets go on. If you are unsure of the total reps, perform the first round at the lower end of the range, then adjust from there. Use assistance on the dip as necessary to perform each set unbroken.
*Shuttle Run: Mark two points 10m apart. 1 rep = there and back.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Seal Stretch; 30-60 sec
2. Scorpion Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Tall Kneeling Triceps Stretch; 30 sec/side

Wednesday, June 17th, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist Minimalist

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or, if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Ankles and Wrists
Ankle Circles x 5 reps/direction
Weighted ankle stretch x 1 min/side
Heel Sit x 1 min
Toe Sit x 1 min
Hand to Hand wrist circles x 30 sec
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Isometrics x 3-5 reps with 5 sec hold
Quadruped Wrist Circles x 5-10 reps/direction

Thursday, June 18th, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist Minimalist

A) Daily Focus Notes:
KOT Split Squat + KOT Squat
KOT means knees over toes. Both exercises ask the knee to travel as far forward as possible. This builds strength across the full range of motion of the knee joint and can help reduce knee pain over time. Focus on control and do not cut the range short.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Straight Leg Bridge Hold; 30 sec
3. Wall Sit; 40-60 sec

C) Strength Intensity (12-15 min):
3 sets
1. Dumbbell Suitcase KOT Split Squat; 10 reps/side @21X0 Tempo
- rest 30 sec
1. Assisted KOT Squat; 10-15 reps @30X0 Tempo
- rest 60-90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set of each movement to determine the starting weight. Set 1-3: aim for RPE 7, 8, 9, respectively.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Goblet Tall Kneel to Stand; 10 reps/side @20X1 Tempo
- directly into
1. Goblet Cossack Squat; 10 reps/side @20X1 Tempo
- rest 90-120 sec between sets
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets. Set 1-3, aim for RPE 7,8,9 respectively.

E) Conditioning (15 Minutes):
3 Sets; increasing pace each round.
30-40 Double Unders or 40-50 Single Unders

20 Dumbbell Suitcase Drop Lunge (10/side)
10 Box Jump Overs
30-40 Double Unders or 40-50 Single Unders
rest walk 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:
The goal of this conditioning piece is to continue to accumulate fatigue in the lower body. For each set, aim to increase the speed of jump rope and bodyweight movements. For the DB Lunge, select a weight that is about an RPE 7 on the first set, and then keep that weight for the remainder of the sets.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Reclining Hero Pose; 60 sec
2. Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30-60 sec/side
3. Pigeon Stretch; 30 sec/side

Friday, June 19th, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist Minimalist

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Supinated Pull Up
The supinated grip puts the biceps in a stronger position on the bar, which means more help from the arms on every rep. Use that to push the weight or reduce band assistance further than you could with a pronated grip. Six reps is a strength focus range. Each set should feel tough.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
-
3 Sets
1. Scap Pull Up; 5-7 reps with 3 sec pause and 3 sec lower.
2. DB Arm Bar; 5-7 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (10-12 min):
3-4 sets
Supinated Strict Pull Up; 6 reps @20X0 Tempo; rest 90 sec between sets
Loading Note:

Perform 2-3 warmup sets. For Set 1-4, aim for RPE 7, 8, 9, and 10, respectively. Match assistance or additional weight to make sure each set is challenging. Weeks 1 and 3 will focus more on strength for the Pull Up, while Weeks 2 and 4 will focus more on high volume and hypertrophy.
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D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
1. Dumbbell Push Press; 6-8 reps @30X1 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15 sec
1. Dumbbell Bent Over Reverse Fly; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 90-120 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set for each movement. Aim for each noncomplimentary superset to be close to failure.

E) Conditioning (15 minutes):
For Time
10-8-6-4-2
Wall Walks or 2x Inchworm Push Ups
20-16-12-8-4
Dumbbell Gorilla Row (R+L=2)
20-16-12-8-4
Hanging Knee Tuck
*30m Farmer's Walk between rounds
15 min time cap.
Effort Note:
The heart rate should not spike very high during this conditioning piece. Each movement is intentionally designed to slow you down. Try to move consistently throughout the entire workout. Select a weight for the Farmer's Walk that is challenging but you can complete unbroken for at least the first 10 minutes of the workout.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Passive Hang; 30 sec
2. Sidelying Thoracic Rotation with Reach; 5 reps/side
3. PVC Box Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30-60sec

Saturday, June 20th, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist Minimalist

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
40 min total work

Part 1: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
250-300m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
- 10 Alternating Low Switch Cossack Squats
- 10 Side Plank Hip Taps/side
*return to Row or Jog and repeat

Part 2: 20 min timer (continuous movement):
250-300m Row or Jog
then stop and do the following:
- 10 Reverse Plank Bridge with Hip Lift (hold 15 sec on last rep)
- 10 Tuck Ups (hold 15 sec on last rep)
*return to Row or Jog and repeat

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (20 min):
20 min Full Body
1. Neck Circles x 3 reps/side
2. Kneeling Segmented Cat Cow x 5 reps
3. Banded Pass Through x 10 reps
4. Quadruped Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side
5. Yoga Push Up x 5 reps
6. Squat to Shinbox Switch x 10 reps/side
7. Squat Hip Rotations x 10 reps
8. Squat Thoracic Rotations x 5 reps/side
9. Cossack Squat x 5 reps/side
10. Long Split Squat x 30 sec/side
11. Forward Fold with Rotation x 5 reps/side

Sunday, June 21st, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist Minimalist

Over the next four weeks, I want to walk you through what I consider the four essentials for making real progress. Not hacks, not shortcuts, just the foundational things that actually move the needle when you get them right. We'll cover one each week, and by the end you'll have a clearer picture of where your energy is best spent.

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Marcus